

Rep. Tom Emmer on Twin Cities News Talk

News Talk

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****JOHN:**

** Representative Tom Emmer joins us. Good morning, Tom, and I just wanted to say continued prayers for you and your family as well on your recent loss, and sorry to hear about that, my friend.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Hey, thanks a lot, John. She was great. She's still there. And same thing to AK. I understand he might have lost a father-in-law yesterday, so.

****JOHN:**

** Yeah, grandmother-in-law, grandmother-in-law, thank you.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Grandmother-in-law, I'm sorry, man. You know what, it happens to all of us. We just hope that people have a great life and can go in peace.

****JOHN:**

** Yeah. It's all good, man. It's all good. Makes us think of our friend Andrew Lee, John. Makes us think of the general. I was just reminiscing about him on the show earlier this week and telling Melinda just yesterday that none of us are getting any younger, as I was discussing the arthritis in my left knee. So let's get to a couple of-

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** My arthritis is between my ears, John, so you're lucky.

****JOHN:**

** So back in January, the House of Representatives, Tom Emmer, voted to go forward with a plan to overturn a 20-year ban on mining near the Boundary Waters Canoe Area Wilderness, the BWCAW. The bill went on to the Senate for consideration, and now, as of this week, even though Senator Tina Smith is very upset over this, the Senate did vote to overturn the ban on copper and nickel mining in the Boundary Waters. I know this is an issue you've talked about quite a bit, been on the forefront of. Your thoughts on the Senate finally moving forward on what you guys had passed in the House earlier this year?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, look, first, I am so happy for Congressman Pete Stauber. This is something that I've been involved in for more than a decade. I mean, I remember growing up in Minnesota in the early 70s when busloads of kids would be coming down from the high schools on the Iron Range, and those mining communities were thriving. We were actually logging. We were making the best use in the most efficient way of the natural resources that

the good Lord has blessed our great state with, John. And then all of a sudden, the Twin Cities liberals started worshipping at the altar of nature, their own version of nature. And it seems as though they don't want us to continue our way of life in Minnesota. They don't even want anyone to experience the North unless they experience it the way some Twin Cities Minneapolis liberal says is okay, which is get in a canoe and witness the beauty of the Boundary Waters. Look, congratulations to Pete Stauber. This has been a mission of his. This is one of the reasons that we fought so hard to get him there. This is kudos to him. It's kudos to Donald J. Trump and his administration. For those of you that are listening, that love the Boundary Waters, understand I love the Boundary Waters. Pete Stauber loves the Boundary Waters. We are all going to protect the Boundary Waters. You are going to be inundated with false messaging from the worthless Star Tribune again, and all the Minneapolis liberals that don't even live up there. But they want to impact the way of life that's up there. The water is more clean in this part of Minnesota than anywhere else. There are so many things to point at, and this is going to stay that way. It will preserve northern Minnesota just as much as now. It will give us access to critical minerals, one of the largest deposits in the world, John. And just think what that's going to do for the communities up there and for the state of Minnesota. Unfortunately, until you change this completely incompetent governor and the Democrats that are running our state on behalf of the fraudsters that have been ripping us off for years, nothing will change. So we have created an economic opportunity, a driver for the future of Minnesota. Now it's up to Minnesotans to show up in November and clean house, get these Democrats out of office.

****JOHN:**

** I had a comment that came in as we talked with Representative Tom Emmer regarding the issue in the Boundary Waters. I wanted to share your iHeartRadio app. Talkbacks are brought to you by Lindahl Realty. Good morning, John. Just a comment on this Boundary Waters thing that came out of Congress yesterday. That Boundary Waters has a specific border to protect the area inside of there. It doesn't give anybody the right to try to control what happens outside of that boundary. Just because the Boundary Waters is there doesn't mean that you can curtail what you can do with property outside of that area. Does that ring true in your mind there, Tom Emmer? Is that an accurate comment?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Yeah, it's not just that, John. I mean, first off, yes, there is a boundary of the Boundary Waters. But what he left out is that there is a buffer around the boundary. So there's a boundary outside of which you are not in the Boundary Waters. And then there is a three mile boundary or buffer outside of that boundary that you can't do any type of disruptive activities. And the other thing that we got to keep in mind, if you look at the map in the Iron Range in the eastern side of it, it actually sits above the Laurentian Divide. And for people who have forgotten elementary school science, the Laurentian Divide, there's a reason why you can go to the headwaters of the Mississippi, because that divide is where water flows south and above the divide, it flows north. So keep in mind, if you are doing mining activities south of the Laurentian Divide, where do you think that's going to go? By the way, this is not our grandfather and grandmother's mining. The type of mining they're talking about is very targeted, very focused. It's a lot like health care today. We don't just flood the body. We do targeted, very laser focused treatments. That's the same thing that we're going to be looking at here. This is cutting edge stuff. And it's about national security and it's about the life, the lifestyle of northern Minnesotans.

****JOHN:**

** Yeah, it's mining with a scalpel, not a hatchet. So, Tom, I also wanted to ask you about the continued funding fight over DHS. Where do you think stand currently now in D.C. regarding that funding issue?

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** Well, this is the now the longest shutdown of any part of government in the history of our government. And look, let's let's preface it with this is because Democrats are answering to their Marxist, socialist, communist based on the far left. And really what they want, what they want is some major disruption. They want some I'm going to argue and I know this is probably controversial. They would love to see some type of terrorist event, some type of awful event that then requires a response from the Trump administration. And then they're going to blame the Trump administration because they're the ones in charge. This is the most disgusting partisan act you could possibly do. Putting Americans safety at risk because of your political desires. It's just it's it's outrageous. Where is it? It's where it was a month ago. It's where it was a month and a half ago. The House has passed over and over a full funding bill that was, by the way, agreed to bipartisan and bicameral. In other words, Republicans and Democrats in the House agreed to the Department of Homeland Security funding bill and Democrats and Republicans in the Senate did before Chuck Schumer and the Senate Democrats reneged on that deal. So it still sits there. The goal is reconciliation to which our speaker wanted to do a different approach, pick up some of the things that were left on the cutting room floor last summer. But now that's going to have to wait because what they're going to do in the Senate, it looks like, is a slim, slim reconciliation bill that is limited to the Department of Homeland Security. And move it quickly, hopefully within the next week or so. Once that happens, then hopefully we'll be able to move it out of the House quickly and get that funded and working again. It is just outrageous what these Democrats are willing to do, what they're willing to put the people who they're working for at risk to accomplish is is outrageous. John.

****JOHN:**

** Representative Tom Emmer, as always, thank you for the time this morning. It's good to check in with you once again. Hopefully we can do it again next week.

****REP. TOM EMMER:**

** All right, man, enjoy your kind of weather.

****JOHN:**

** Thank you, Tom. We'll talk to you again real soon.

This transcript was independently produced by MN-06 Watch for accountability and archival purposes.

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